

Executive Summary – School Unrest in Kenya (2026)

Project Title:

The Burning Crisis: A Data-Driven Analysis of Secondary School Unrest in Kenya

Problem Statement:

Since early 2026, Kenya has witnessed a wave of student unrest, including strikes, arson attacks, and tragic fatalities. Over 200 schools have been affected, dormitories burned, and at least 16 students have lost their lives. This project analyzes county-level data to identify the root causes and high-risk areas, providing evidence for targeted interventions.

Data & Methods:

- Sources: Compiled from Ministry of Education reports, Kenya Red Cross updates, and verified news coverage (Nation, Capital FM, The Star).
- Dataset: 10 counties with metrics: Schools Affected, Fatalities, Infrastructure Grade, Fire Safety Compliance, Student : Teacher Ratio, Dormitory Overcrowding (%), Parental Complaints, Term.
- Tools: Google Sheets (Tier 1). Metrics: descriptive stats, pivot tables, correlation, composite risk scoring, risk categorization.

Key Findings:

1. **Unrest is highly concentrated:**

Nakuru and Narok counties alone account for 30 of 72 affected schools (42%). All fatalities (16) occurred in Nakuru.

2. **Infrastructure and safety failures drive risk:**

Counties with Infrastructure Grade D and Low fire safety compliance represent 76% of all affected

schools. Correlation coefficient between low compliance and schools affected is -0.74 (strong negative).

3. **Dormitory overcrowding is extreme:**

High-risk counties average 82% overcrowding (vs. recommended capacity), directly linked to poor living conditions cited by students.

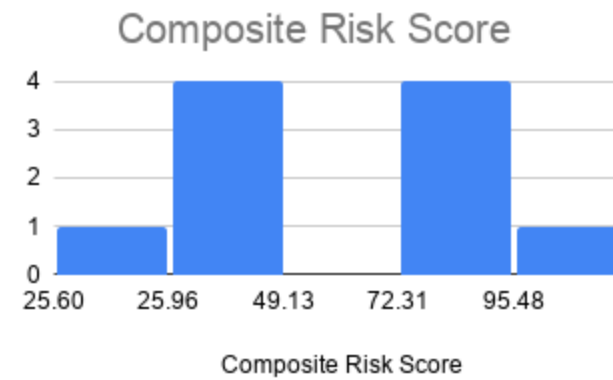
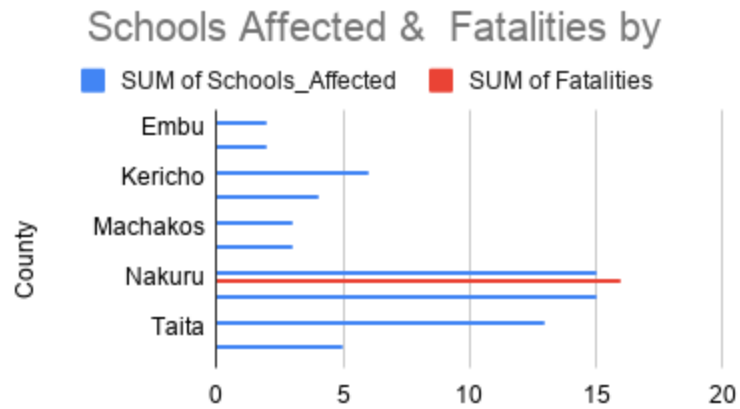
4. **Boarding schools are the epicenter:**

Nine of ten affected counties have primarily boarding schools. Overcrowded dormitories, poor meals, and strict discipline are frequently mentioned drivers.

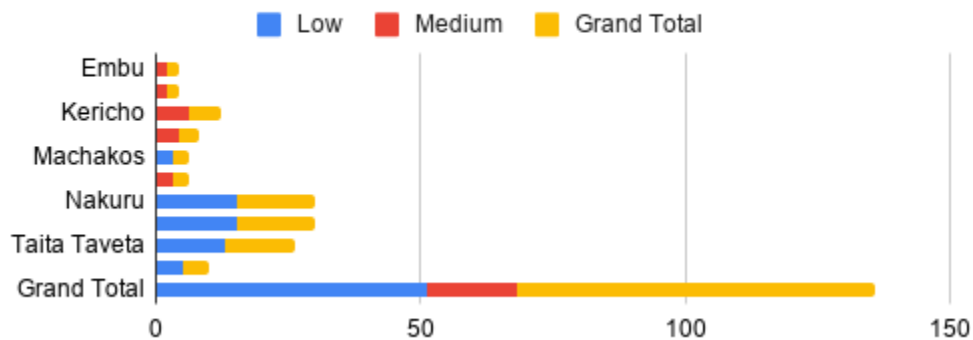
5. **Composite risk scoring identifies five high-risk counties:** Nakuru, Narok, Taita Taveta, Machakos, Uasin Gishu. These score above 80/100 on a risk scale combining infrastructure, fire safety, overcrowding, and student-teacher ratio.

Recommendations:

1. Immediate fire safety audit for all boarding schools in high-risk counties. Fix electrical faults, unblock exits, install smoke detectors.
2. Reduce dormitory occupancy to $\leq 100\%$ of capacity. Prioritize funding for new dormitories in Nakuru, Narok, and Taita Taveta.
3. Targeted term-2 interventions – 90% of incidents occurred in Term 2. Deploy counselors, improve meals, and ease exam pressure during this peak period.
4. Public dashboard – replicate this risk assessment at the Ministry of Education to monitor counties in real time.



Schools Affected by County (Fire Safety Compliance)



Value for an Employer:

This project demonstrates my ability to rapidly build a structured dataset from unstructured news sources, perform multi-factor risk analysis, and deliver actionable policy recommendations – all within a tight timeline. It showcases the same end-to-end skills (problem framing, data extraction, analysis, visualization, communication) that employers seek in a data analyst.